

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*

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## Vincent Van Faux

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*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

## INTRODUCTIONS

### Vincent Van Faux

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#### *Celebrated Contemporary Painter*

Vincent believes even his shopping lists belong in a retrospective. Vincent became famous young and has been trying ever since to convince people that this is not the same thing as becoming famous accidentally.

- Went to art school with **Dada DiCapo**. **Dada** enjoys reminding Vincent of this in front of collectors.
- **Hugh Bidder** wants to represent Vincent. Vincent has yet to approve **Hugh**'s percentage.
- **Penny Pincher** keeps showing Vincent photos of paintings and asking what they are worth.

#### ACTING TIPS

Warm, competitive, mercurial, self-aware enough to joke about his ego but not enough to lose it.

#### YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Vincent Van Faux. My work is here tonight. My early work is also here, despite several very expensive objections.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

# INTRODUCTIONS

Vincent Van Faux

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## Behind the portrait

### Your grievance with Grant

Grant owned an embarrassing student painting you have spent years trying to buy back. He planned to display it tonight beside your celebrated recent work as a joke about 'humble beginnings.'

### Your other secret

You have secretly used buyers to acquire several of your own early paintings so you could remove them from circulation. The art world would find that both vain and market-manipulative.

### Conversations to start

- Find out whether Ella Gance knows you were behind the anonymous buybacks.
- Persuade Claire O'Scuro that the student painting should not be displayed.

*If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings; save corrections for Coming Clean.*

Memorize your animal and return the slip. When the host announces the selected animal, use IF MURDERER if it matches yours; otherwise use IF INNOCENT. Never read an IF heading aloud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

## HUNT FOR CLUES

Vincent Van Faux

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# The museum has misplaced its paperwork. Naturally.

Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the house. These three hints lead to three different hiding places. Leave the furniture and household objects where they are. Bring an envelope to the Evidence Table; read and share the discovery inside.

- 1** *Look inside the vessel that usually gives cut flowers a place to stand.*
- 2** *Find the green light, then examine the space nearby.*
- 3** *Find the biography of the man who chose conscience over obedience. Its pages have company.*

Already found? Read that discovery at the Evidence Table, then try another hint. Ask for help reaching a hiding place; nobody needs to climb. You may investigate together.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

## ACT I: MOTIVE

Vincent Van Faux

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### Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament**

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

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**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir**

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

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**Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid**

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

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**Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions**

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

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**Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme**

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

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**Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop**

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

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**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist**

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

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**Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks**

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

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**Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

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**Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote**

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

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*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

## ACT I: MOTIVE

Vincent Van Faux

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### Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.  
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

### EVERYONE / READ ALOUD

Perhaps we can exhibit his manners next. Grant owned a student painting I have spent years trying to buy back. Tonight he wanted it beside my celebrated work as a joke about humble beginnings. I did not consent to being the punchline of my own exhibition.

*You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

## ACT II: OPPORTUNITY

Vincent Van Faux

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### Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament**

Where were you before the toast, and why?

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**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir**

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

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**Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid**

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

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**Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions**

Where did your work take you before the toast?

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**Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme**

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

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**Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop**

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

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**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist**

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

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**Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks**

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

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**Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

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**Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote**

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

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*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

## ACT II: OPPORTUNITY

Vincent Van Faux

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### Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.  
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

#### IF INNOCENT

Earlier, about 6:31 by my watch, I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to compare the glaze with the red velvet shelf beneath it. By the toast I was in the East Gallery, outside the alcove, avoiding discussion of my student painting. Perhaps we can exhibit his manners next.

#### IF MURDERER

At about 6:45 by my phone, I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to compare the blue glaze with the red velvet shelf beneath it. A bad colour relationship can ruin an otherwise respectable object. I had approached the salon to discuss the label for my student work.

*You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.*



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## ACT III: METHOD

Vincent Van Faux

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### Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament**

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

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**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir**

What materials or records passed through your hands?

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**Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid**

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

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**Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions**

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

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**Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme**

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

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**Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop**

Which objects or records need your explanation?

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**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist**

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

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**Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks**

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

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**Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

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**Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote**

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

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*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

## ACT III: METHOD

Vincent Van Faux

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### Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.  
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

### EVERYONE / READ ALOUD

I also bought back early paintings through secret buyers to take them out of circulation. Call it vanity if you like; I have heard worse from reviewers with less talent. The student label here was meant to humiliate me. My plan was to remove that label and survive the evening.

### Evidence Table / discovery index

- |                                  |                                   |
|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| 1. Gift agreement                | 9. Education reallocation         |
| 2. Shipping manifest / 1988      | 10. Donor Salon camera            |
| 3. A warning left behind         | 11. Donation entry / 1989         |
| 4. GRANT'S NIGHT OF GLORY        | 12. Closing reveal / concept      |
| 5. Treatment finding             | 13. Display proposal / superseded |
| 6. Donor agreement / margin copy | 14. Clock inspection slip         |
| 7. Auction result                | 15. Cancelled programme cue       |
| 8. Vincent Van Faux              | 16. Grant Larceny's toast         |



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
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## ACCUSATIONS

Vincent Van Faux

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### Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Fold this loose page writing inward and give only the ballot to the host. Keep your packet for Coming Clean. Votes lock when all ballots are collected.

**Your character name**

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**I accuse**

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**Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction**

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**Best Actor**

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**Best Costume**

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**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
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## COMING CLEAN

Vincent Van Faux

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### The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. If none confesses, the host calls the selected animal to stand. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

#### IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I bought back early paintings through secret buyers. My claim to compare the glaze with the red velvet shelf beneath it was invented. I borrowed that detail from the abandoned cabinet proposal to conceal my preparations. At the toast I really was outside the alcove in the East Gallery, as I told you. That false errand covered my other misconduct; I did not poison Grant Larceny.

#### IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

Perhaps we can exhibit his manners next. Grant owned a student painting I have spent years trying to buy back. Tonight he wanted it beside my celebrated work as a joke about humble beginnings. I did not consent to being the punchline of my own exhibition. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*